

01 – RESEARCH: GEN Z USER & MARKET GAP ANALYSIS

Target User Profile (Gen Z Urban Creative)

- **Demographics:** Ages 18–25, urban students, creative freelancers and young professionals.
- **Lifestyle:** High mobility (commuting, campus life, cafes, music festivals). Hands-free EDC focus.
- **Core Values:** Authenticity, versatility, sustainable materials (veg-tan leather) and craft heritage.

Identified Market Gaps & Opportunities

1. *Rigidity vs. Comfort:* Traditional leather bags are heavy and stiff; Gen Z needs body-conforming ergonomics.
2. *Single-Wear Limitations:* Most slings offer one wear mode; Gen Z expects multi-way adaptability.
3. *Superficial Branding:* Mass-market slings lack cultural storytelling; opportunity for authentic Indian craft motifs.

Material Selection Rationale

- **Primary:** 1.6 mm milled vegetable-tanned full-grain leather (durable, natural patina aging).
- **Secondary:** Organic cotton canvas lining, deep indigo webbing strap and upcycled leather trims for textural contrast.
- **Hardware:** Antiqued brass swivel clasps and FIDLOCK magnetic quick-release buckle.

Use Scenarios: One Bag, Three Days

Morning commute – Crossbody

Phone, power bank and a small notebook ride at the hip. The hidden rear pocket keeps metro card and cash against the body.

Festival or crowded campus – Chest rig

Strap shortened at the FIDLOCK buckle lifts the bag high on the chest: hands-free, in view and out of reach of crowds.

Late cafe or travel – Waist pouch

Strap re-routed through the rear tunnels makes a belt bag that keeps passport, earbuds and cables close.

Competitive Market Benchmark

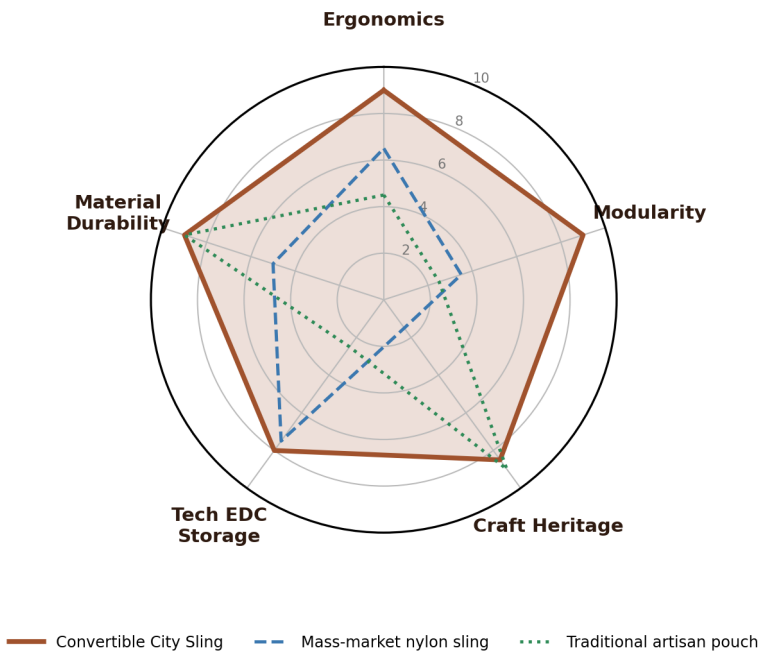


Figure 1.1: Radar comparison of the Convertible City Sling against mass-market nylon slings and traditional artisan leather pouches across 5 criteria.

Scoring basis: scores (1–10) are the designer's own assessment from a spec comparison, not lab-tested. Ergonomics = contoured crescent + 3 carry positions. Modularity = number of wear modes (3 vs 1). Craft Heritage = documented Indian craft techniques. Tech EDC = dedicated organizer + secured pocket. Durability = full-grain veg-tan vs nylon.

02 – INSPIRATION: MOOD BOARD & CULTURAL CRAFT INTEGRATION

Indian Craft Heritage Integration

- **Santiniketan-style hand-embossed leatherwork:** the lower front panel uses blind embossing with geometric motifs, giving tactile depth to the smooth leather surface.
- **Kolhapuri leather braiding:** the top handle and strap anchor points use hand-braided leather binding, reinforcing high-stress joinery while celebrating Indian artisanal craftsmanship.

Visual Mood & Aesthetics

- Fusing *Urban Utility* with *Artisanal Heritage*.
- Tactile contrast between smooth full-grain leather, embossed panels and antiqued metallic hardware.

Material Specification Matrix

Component	Material Spec	Finish / Color
Main Body	1.6 mm veg-tan leather	Terracotta / milled
Accent Panel	2.0 mm veg-tan leather	Hand-embossed
Strap Joint & Handle	Braided leather strip	Kolhapuri weave
Strap	38 mm cotton webbing	Deep indigo
Lining	Organic cotton canvas	Deep navy
Buckle & Hardware	FIDLOCK V-buckle, swivel hooks, D-rings	Antiqued brass (Obsidian: black anodized)

Why These Two Crafts

Santiniketan is known for embossed leather goods with floral and geometric motifs; Kolhapur for braided vegetable-tanned leather. The sling uses each where it does real work: embossing for surface identity, braiding for load-bearing joints, so heritage is functional, not decorative.

Color Palette & Swatches



Terracotta Leather (#A0522D)
Usage: Primary body



Santiniketan Tan (#D4A373)
Usage: Embossed panel



Deep Indigo (#1D2D44)
Usage: Webbing strap + canvas lining



Antiqued Brass (#B8860B)
Usage: Hardware (Terracotta edition)



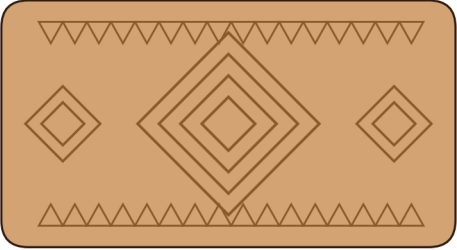
Obsidian Black (#1A1A1A)
Usage: Body, Obsidian edition



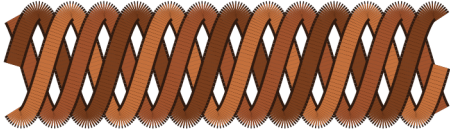
Black Anodized (#2B2B2B)
Usage: Hardware (Obsidian edition)

Figure 2.1: Inspired by natural clay, indigo dyes and aged brass hardware.

Craft Motifs



Blind-embossed geometric motif (schematic)



Hand-braided edge binding (schematic)

Figure 2.2: Schematic of the blind-embossed geometric panel (left) and hand-braided edge binding (right).

03 – EXPLORATION: FORM SILHOUETTE & CONVERSION MECHANICS

Selected Silhouette: Organic Curved Crescent

- *Why organic curved?* Evaluated against boxy and angular forms. The crescent gives superior body-conforming ergonomics, drape and visual lightness while highlighting natural leather grain.
- *Volume optimization:* the curved bottom gusset expands when loaded without bulging awkwardly against the torso.

3-Way Modular Conversion System

One strap, one buckle, three ways to wear it: **Crossbody** for commuting, **Tactical Chest Rig** for hands-free mobility, **Waist / Hip Pouch** via the rear leather tunnels.

Form Exploration Matrix

Form Type	Ergonomics	Gen Z Appeal	Status
Angular Geometry	Moderate (stiff edges)	High (techwear)	Rejected
Organic Curved	Excellent (body-hugging)	Very high (crescent trend)	SELECTED
Boxy Structure	Fair (bulky)	Moderate (classic)	Rejected

3-Way Wearability Diagram

1 CROSSBODY



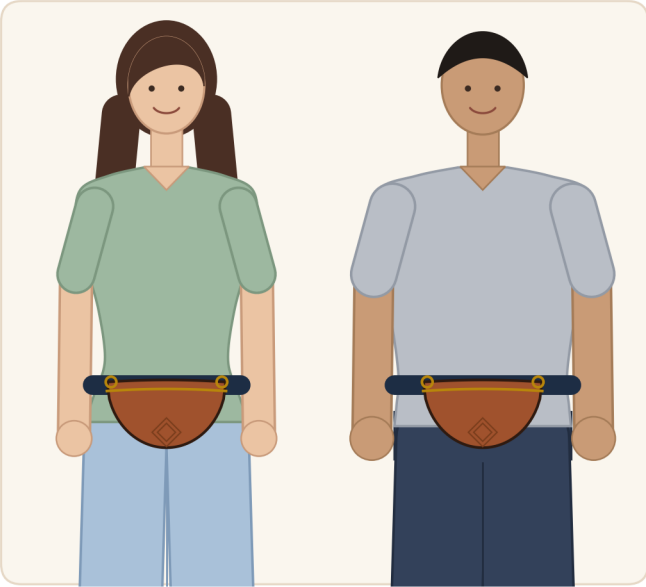
Convert: hook the 360° swivel snap hooks onto the end D-rings, slide the strap to full length and wear it across the body.

2 TACTICAL CHEST RIG



Convert: slide the strap shorter at the FIDLOCK V-buckle, which closes magnetically with one hand, and lift the bag to the chest.

3 WAIST / HIP POUCH



Convert: thread the strap through the two rear leather tunnels and close it at the front for belt-bag wear.

Figure 3.1: Illustrated 3-way conversion on a female (left) and male (right) model, using swivel snap hooks and the FIDLOCK buckle. Schematic illustration; proportions indicative.

04 – ROUGH SKETCHES: PROCESS & DESIGN EVOLUTION

Process Sheets Summary & Design Reasoning

Sheet 1: Contour & Proportions

Early AI-assisted concept sketches refined the crescent width from 22 cm to 28 cm, optimizing storage for smartphones, power banks and small notebooks without losing sleekness.

Sheet 2: Swivel Joint & Anchor Point Mechanics

Compared 3 attachment mechanisms. Selected antiqued brass 360° swivel snap hooks with hand-braided leather eyelets to prevent strap twisting during rapid conversion.

Sheet 3: Internal Tech EDC Layout

Internal neoprene organizer slots and elastic loops for TWS earbud cases, pens and cables keep contents secure during motion.

Sheet 4: Hidden Body-Facing Security Pocket

A concealed rear zip pocket against the wearer's torso protects passport and cash in crowded urban environments.

Design Evolution: From Concept to Final

Stage	Form	Decision
Concept sketch	Flap-front saddle bag with hidden magnetic snap	Not taken forward: flap adds bulk against the torso and slows access
Refined	Zip-top crescent, 28 x 16 x 8 cm	Selected: flatter, body-hugging, zip security
Final (Section 5)	Crescent + rear security pocket, rear tunnels, FIDLOCK strap	Frozen for technical drawing and rendering

Concept Rough Sketch Sheet (AI-assisted)



Figure 4.1: AI-assisted concept sketch sheet (generated with Gemini from the designer's brief) used for early form exploration, conversion arrows, Kolhapuri braid and Santiniketan emboss details. The flap saddle form shown was explored and then replaced by the zip-top crescent in Section 5.

05 – FINAL DESIGN: TECHNICAL DRAWINGS & SPECIFICATIONS

Technical Orthographic Views

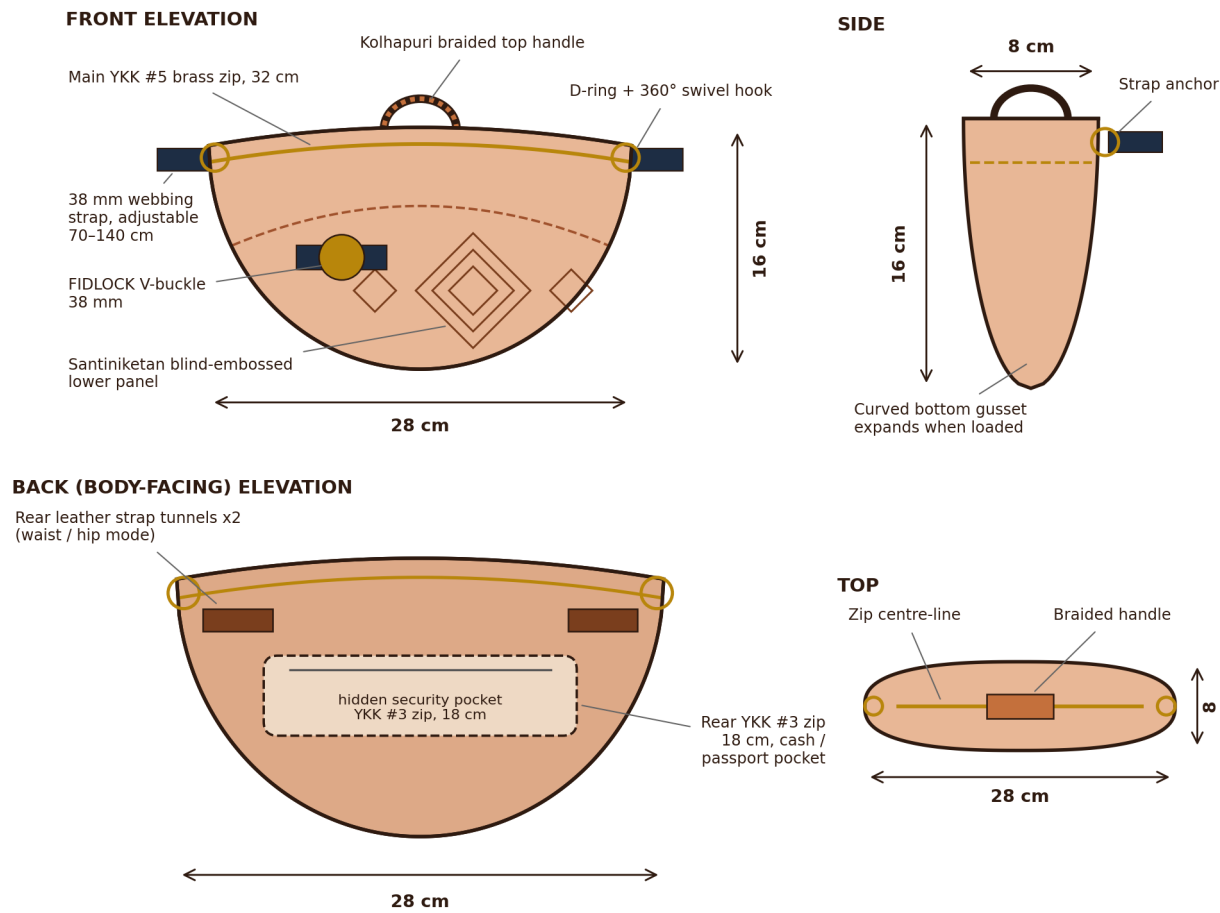


Figure 5.1: Scale technical drawings of the final crescent (28 x 16 x 8 cm): front, side, back (body-facing) and top, with callouts for YKK zippers, FIDLOCK buckle, braided handle, rear tunnels and Santiniketan embossed panel.

Bill of Materials (BOM) & Specifications

Item	Description	Qty
Leather A	1.6 mm milled veg-tan (terracotta): body, gusset	3.2 sq ft
Leather B	2.0 mm firm veg-tan, embossed: lower panel	1.1 sq ft
Lining	Organic cotton canvas (navy)	2.5 sq ft
Strap	38 mm cotton webbing (indigo), adjustable 70–140 cm	1
Top handle	Kolhapuri-weave braided leather strip	1 (14 cm)
Rear tunnels	Leather loops, 40 mm inner width	2
Main zipper	YKK #5 metal (brass)	1 (32 cm)
Rear zipper	YKK #3 nylon coil	1 (18 cm)
Main buckle	FIDLOCK V-buckle 38 mm	1 unit
Snap hooks	360° swivel snap hook (brass)	2 units
D-rings	38 mm heavy D-rings (brass)	4 units
Organizer	Neoprene slots + elastic loops	1 set
Thread	T-70 bonded nylon	As req.

Obsidian edition: same BOM with black-milled leather and black anodized hardware (buckle, hooks, D-rings, zipper pulls).

06 – RENDERING: HERO PRESENTATION & COLORWAYS

Primary Edition: Heritage Terracotta



Warm terracotta veg-tan leather with Santiniketan-style embossed lower panel, indigo webbing strap and antiqued brass hardware.

Variant Edition: Obsidian Midnight Black



Stealth edition: matte black-milled leather, dark indigo accent stitching and black anodized hardware.

Edition	Body	Hardware	Strap & Lining	Stitching
Heritage Terracotta	1.6 mm veg-tan, terracotta	Antiqued brass	Indigo webbing, navy canvas	Tan, T-70 bonded nylon
Obsidian Midnight Black	1.6 mm veg-tan, black-milled	Black anodized	Indigo webbing, navy canvas	Dark indigo, T-70 bonded nylon

Renders were generated with Gemini (AI) from the final specification in Section 5 and are visual representations of the design intent. Technical drawings in Section 5 govern dimensions and construction.